

RETAINED SEARCH / WORKING TEMPLATE

Executive Search Brief Template

The brief structure we use to align boards, investors, and hiring leaders before a retained search begins. Complete each section to create a shared, decision-ready definition of the mandate.

Mandate context

- Business situation and why this role matters now.
- Reporting line, key relationships, and team scope.
- Stakeholders who must align on the hire (board, investors, peers).
- Confidentiality requirements and communication constraints.

The role

- Mandate for the first 12 to 24 months, expressed as outcomes.
- The 4 to 6 capabilities that most predict success.
- Operating range and scale required (and not required).
- Culture-add the team needs, in concrete behaviours.

Candidate market

- Target sectors and company profiles to map.
- Profiles to avoid and lessons from prior hires.
- Compensation framework and flexibility.

Process and assessment

- Assessment criteria and who evaluates what.
- Interview stages, panel, and decision owners.
- Timeline, checkpoints, and target decision date.

Success measures

- What 'a great hire' looks like at 6 and 12 months.
- Onboarding plan and named onboarding owner.
- Risks to manage and how they will be mitigated.

Working through this live? Talent Pathfinder partners advise boards, CEOs, and investors on the decisions in this brief. Request a confidential consultation at talentpathfinder.com/contact.